Thousands are marching in Jerusalem. The American ambassador launched the march, and Lapid spoke; no significant incidents. A counterdemonstration took place some streets away. The police managed to keep both groups separated.

Actually, Israeli society has been divided into quite a number of hostile segments from the beginnings of immigration to the country, as I already mentioned, on ideological, ethnic, religious, and all other possible grounds. Yet a sense of shared fate as Jews and objects of steady hostility, then as targets of successive aggressions, of wars and constant terror attacks, created a feeling of community stronger than any divisions. I wonder whether the present dissensions would disappear in case of another war, probably a costlier one in lives and destruction than the previous ones. Israel's enemies may be counting on an internal fracture deeper than ever before within the national community, one that no attack would heal and that would affect its ability to defend itself as effectively as in the past. Could they be right?

On a similar note, in the news there is increasing talk of the growing danger of Iran getting its atom bomb and of Israel having to launch an attack against the Shiite state's nuclear installations, with or without American help. This would be the most dangerous and complex operation that Israel ever undertook. In the present atmosphere, it is not clear at all that the Jewish state would get any external help.

US Secretary of State Blinken is in the region and was planning to visit Israel until this morning, when he canceled his stopover. Strange, but one more signal of American displeasure with Israeli policies.

Friday, June 2

I never thought much of Hugh Trevor-Roper as a historian. For most people he reached his nadir when he confirmed the authenticity of the Hitler diaries